YOUR MAP · FOOD STUFF IS BRAIN STUFF

FIND YOUR (HARD) JOB.

Eating is five jobs before the first bite. Most of us find one or two harder than the rest, and it can change day to day. That's brain stuff. Not a character flaw.

for you, or for someone you care for.



ONE PAGE. FIVE JOBS.
one thing to try for yours.

THE FIVE JOBS

tick any that sound familiar, then pick one to start with.

01 NOTICE

Noticing hunger before it's urgent.

IT CAN LOOK LIKE

"Wasn't hungry. Just foggy and cranky."

For some brains, the signal runs quiet.

ONE THING TO TRY

Eat by the clock, not the signal. Set times for meals and snacks. Something every three to four hours is a good place to start.

☐ THIS IS MINE

02 CHOOSE

Deciding what to eat.

IT CAN LOOK LIKE

"Fridge open. Nothing sounds right."

ONE THING TO TRY

Two or three go-to options, decided ahead. The same breakfast every day is fine. Sameness can be a support.

☐ THIS IS MINE

03 PAUSE

Stopping what you're doing.

IT CAN LOOK LIKE

"Just one more. Then it was 3pm."

ONE THING TO TRY

A five-minute warning, then a real stop. Save your place first, so coming back is easy. Or eat alongside someone.

☐ THIS IS MINE

04 PREP

Getting food ready.

IT CAN LOOK LIKE

"Too many steps. Crackers it is."

ONE THING TO TRY

Keep food that needs nothing doing within reach. Crackers count. On hard days, a ready-made meal still counts.

☐ THIS IS MINE

05 START

Taking the first bite.

IT CAN LOOK LIKE

"It's right there. I still haven't."

ONE THING TO TRY

Put it in your hand, not back in the fridge. Start with one bite of something easy.

☐ THIS IS MINE

MY HARD JOB IS

THIS WEEK I'LL TRY

NOT A TEST

If food has started to feel frightening, the list of foods keeps getting shorter, thoughts about food or your body are taking up a lot of room, or weight, energy or growth is changing, that's worth a GP visit.

there's no bad enough. you're allowed to start now.

On ADHD medication and eating has got harder? Tell your prescriber. They can adjust things.

TAKE IT WITH YOU

Bring this page to your GP, paediatrician or therapist. Showing them your ticked job, how long it's been hard and what you've tried is a good way to start. Medicare rebates may be available with a mental health treatment plan (often called a mental health care plan) from your usual GP.

ask for a longer appointment.

Filling this in for a child or teen? Tick the job you see most, and try one thing together. kids, teens and adults all welcome.

Body Belonging · Telehealth across Australia
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Book a free 15 minute chat

pull up a chair. no referral needed.

The five jobs is how I explain eating in sessions. The patterns draw on Eating Disorder Neurodiversity Australia, the University of Newcastle's No Money No Time, University of Queensland dietetics, and Cobbaert et al., Journal of Eating Disorders (2026). The lines in handwriting are composites, not anyone's words.

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